



An Artist's Haven

A simple tutorial that will help your tablet digital pen to work on a GNU-powered machine.

There are many graphics designers, artists and game writers who would love to work on GNU/Linux but may find themselves helpless, because one of the most important devices that enables them to create artwork and illustrations—the digital pen—may or may not work on this operating system. Well, the problem arises because although vendors love to advertise the fact that their devices are compatible with Windows and Mac, they don't mention anything about GNU/Linux even if it's supported out of the box. So, the end-user in search of a digital pen has no clue.

I recently bought an iBall pen [WP8060]. I had checked the website and knew that it did not work on GNU/Linux. The only reason I went in for this pen was that iBall's device was the only product available in Delhi at that point of time. Despite knowing that it did not work on GNU/Linux, I deliberately asked the shopkeeper if it did. He said, "No." But he got the message that there are GNU/Linux users interested in using this pen. I replied, "Ah, it will work—everything works on GNU/Linux."

So I got down to work and found that I might have some luck with this device after all. I must mention that the whole credit of this tutorial goes to the fine fellows who developed the drivers and other utility packages, and the bloggers who scribbled down the instructions to use these tools.

I work on Ubuntu 8.10, which will be the target platform for this tutorial. However, other distro users need not worry, as I'll have to start off by compiling from source.

First off, download the latest Wizardpen driver source [wizardpen-0.7.0-alpha2.tar.gz] from <http://tinyurl.com/wizardpen> (I have created a Tiny URL to make it easy for you. You can find the original location in the foot-note to this article.) Uncompress the package after you're done with downloading:

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$ tar -xzf wizardpen-0.7.0-alpha2.tar.gz
```

The next step is to compile this source. However, to successfully do that, download and install the following additional packages:

- xutils